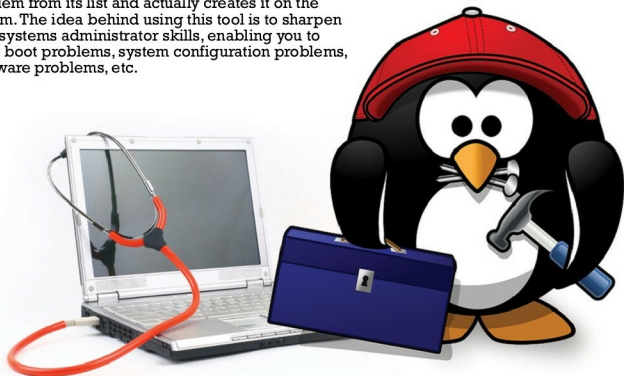


Test Your Troubleshooting Skills With *Trouble-Maker*

Trouble-Maker, as the name suggests, is a Linux tool that, when installed in a system, randomly selects a problem from its list and actually creates it on the system. The idea behind using this tool is to sharpen your systems administrator skills, enabling you to solve boot problems, system configuration problems, hardware problems, etc.



Why do we use tools? To simplify tasks, obviously. But wait a minute; in this article I'm going to introduce a tool that has been created to give you a hard time. Now before you begin to think that I've gone insane to even discuss a tool that's designed to drive people nuts instead of making their lives easier, relax—it will be clear to you soon enough.

This article is all about Trouble-Maker, a handy tool to test your Linux troubleshooting skills. This tool creates an array of problems that you need to identify and rectify. Initially, it sounds like a pain but once you are done with it, you'll have some great troubleshooting skills under your belt. So let's proceed without further delay.

You can download Trouble-Maker from <http://sourceforge.net/projects/trouble-maker/files/> and get installation and running instructions at <http://trouble-maker.sourceforge.net/doc.html>. Once you've installed it, the real action begins. Trouble-Maker has 16 modules (15 actually, because one module is just a dummy and does

nothing), each creating a unique problem for your system, which has to be rectified. There are two ways to launch Trouble-Maker:

```
/usr/local/trouble-maker/bin/trouble-maker.pl
--version=RHEL_5
```

...will run a random module.

```
/usr/local/trouble-maker/bin/trouble-maker.pl
--version=RHEL_5
--selection=name_of_the_module_file
```

...will run a specified module. You'll find 16 .tar files in the `/usr/local/trouble-maker/kitbag` directory. You can use any of these files (including .tar extension) to run that file. For example, there is a file called `do_nothing.tar`, which is a dummy file and it does nothing. You can run it with the following command: